

1.2 Budget Tracking Spreadsheet

Every construction cost, by category — estimated against actual, with per-category subtotals and a whole-project roll-up.

Project Name: _____ Total Budget (\$): _____

Owner-Builder: _____ Date Created: _____

Lender/Financing: _____ Last Updated: _____

INSTRUCTIONS: Track all construction costs by category. Update regularly. Calculate variance (Actual – Estimated). Negative variance = under budget, positive variance = over budget. Monitor percentage of budget used to avoid overruns. Enter figures in dollars — the column headings carry the units.

LAND & SITE COSTS

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Land purchase/lot cost				
Closing costs and fees				
Land survey				
Soil/percolation testing				
LAND & SITE SUBTOTAL				

SITE PREPARATION

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Site clearing and tree removal				
Grading and excavation				
Driveway/access road				
Erosion control measures				
Temporary utilities (power, water)				

SITE PREPARATION

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Portable toilet rental (duration)				
Dumpster rental (duration)				
Storage container/job box				
SITE PREPARATION SUBTOTAL				

FOUNDATION

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Foundation excavation				
Gravel/stone base				
Rebar and wire mesh				
Concrete (footers)				
Concrete (foundation walls/slab)				
Concrete pump rental				
Form lumber and supplies				
Anchor bolts and hardware				
Waterproofing/dampproofing				
Drainage tile and pipe				
Vapor barrier/poly sheeting				
Backfill and compaction				
Foundation labor (if subbed)				
FOUNDATION SUBTOTAL				

FRAMING

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Framing lumber (studs, plates, joists)				
Engineered lumber (LVL, I-joists, etc.)				
Roof trusses or rafters				
Sheathing (wall, floor, roof)				
House wrap/moisture barrier				
Nails, screws, hangers, hardware				
Framing labor (if subbed)				
Crane rental (truss setting)				
FRAMING SUBTOTAL				

ROOFING

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Roofing underlayment (felt/synthetic)				
Shingles/roofing material				
Ridge vent and accessories				
Drip edge and flashing				
Gutters and downspouts				
Roofing labor (if subbed)				
ROOFING SUBTOTAL				

EXTERIOR FINISHES

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Siding material				
Exterior trim boards				
Soffit and fascia				
Exterior paint/stain				
Exterior doors (front, rear, garage)				
Windows				
Exterior labor (if subbed)				
EXTERIOR FINISHES SUBTOTAL				

PLUMBING ROUGH-IN

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Supply pipes (PEX, copper, etc.)				
Drain/waste/vent (DWV) pipes				
Fittings, connectors, valves				
Water heater				
Plumbing rough-in labor (if subbed)				
PLUMBING ROUGH-IN SUBTOTAL				

HVAC ROUGH-IN

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
HVAC unit(s) — furnace/AC/heat pump				

HVAC ROUGH-IN

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Ductwork and registers				
Ventilation fans (bath, kitchen)				
HVAC labor/installation (if subbed)				
HVAC ROUGH-IN SUBTOTAL				

ELECTRICAL ROUGH-IN

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Electrical panel/breaker box				
Wire and cable (Romex, etc.)				
Boxes, connectors, staples				
Service entrance/meter base				
Electrical rough-in labor (if subbed)				
ELECTRICAL ROUGH-IN SUBTOTAL				

INSULATION

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Wall insulation (fiberglass/spray foam)				
Ceiling/attic insulation				
Floor/rim joist insulation				
Insulation labor (if subbed)				
INSULATION SUBTOTAL				

DRYWALL

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Drywall sheets (1/2", 5/8")				
Joint compound (mud)				
Tape, corner bead, screws				
Texture materials (if applicable)				
Drywall labor (hanging, taping, finishing)				
DRYWALL SUBTOTAL				

DOORS & INTERIOR TRIM

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Interior doors (slab and pre-hung)				
Door hardware (knobs, hinges, locks)				
Baseboards				
Window and door casing				
Crown molding (if applicable)				
Closet shelving and rods				
Trim labor (if subbed)				
DOORS & TRIM SUBTOTAL				

FLOORING

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
LVP/vinyl plank flooring				

FLOORING

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Tile (bathroom, kitchen, entry)				
Hardwood flooring				
Carpet (bedrooms, stairs)				
Underlayment and adhesives				
Flooring labor (if subbed)				
FLOORING SUBTOTAL				

CABINETS & COUNTERTOPS

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Kitchen cabinets (base and upper)				
Bathroom vanities				
Kitchen countertops				
Bathroom countertops				
Cabinet hardware (pulls, hinges)				
Cabinet installation labor (if subbed)				
CABINETS & COUNTERTOPS SUBTOTAL				

PLUMBING FIXTURES

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Kitchen sink and faucet				
Bathroom sinks and faucets				

PLUMBING FIXTURES

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Toilets				
Bathtubs				
Shower enclosures and doors				
Shower/tub fixtures and valves				
Plumbing fixture installation labor				
PLUMBING FIXTURES SUBTOTAL				

ELECTRICAL FIXTURES & FINISH

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Light fixtures (interior and exterior)				
Ceiling fans				
Receptacles and switches				
Cover plates				
Doorbell/smoke detectors/CO detectors				
Electrical trim-out labor (if subbed)				
ELECTRICAL FIXTURES SUBTOTAL				

PAINTING

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Interior primer				

PAINTING

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Interior paint				
Exterior primer and paint				
Painting supplies (brushes, rollers, tape)				
Painting labor (if subbed)				
PAINTING SUBTOTAL				

FINISH ITEMS & APPLIANCES

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Kitchen appliances (range, refrigerator, DW)				
Microwave/range hood				
Laundry appliances (washer/dryer)				
Mirrors and shower doors				
Tile backsplash materials and labor				
Garage door and opener				
Deck/patio materials and labor				
FINISH ITEMS SUBTOTAL				

LANDSCAPING & FINAL SITE WORK

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Final grading and drainage				
Topsoil and seeding/sod				

LANDSCAPING & FINAL SITE WORK

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Trees, shrubs, and plantings				
Mulch and landscape fabric				
Driveway paving/concrete				
Walkways and steps				
Mailbox and house numbers				
LANDSCAPING SUBTOTAL				

PERMITS, FEES & INSURANCE

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Building permit				
Electrical permit				
Plumbing permit				
Mechanical/HVAC permit				
Septic/well permits				
Impact/tap fees (water, sewer)				
Builder's risk insurance				
General liability insurance				
Plan review/engineering fees				
PERMITS & INSURANCE SUBTOTAL				

CONTINGENCY & MISCELLANEOUS

Item Description	Estimated Cost (\$)	Actual Cost (\$)	Variance (\$)	Notes / Vendor
Contingency fund (10-15% recommended)				
Tool purchases/rentals				
Miscellaneous supplies				
Cleanup and waste removal				
Inspection fees (beyond permit costs)				
Other: _____				
Other: _____				
CONTINGENCY SUBTOTAL				

BUDGET SUMMARY

Category	Estimated Total (\$)	Actual Total (\$)	% of Budget
GRAND TOTAL — ALL CATEGORIES			
Total Variance (Actual – Estimated)			
Remaining Budget Available			

BUDGET STATUS NOTES
